NIKOLAY DYCHKOV

Location flexible | Open to remote and relocation opportunities | Available for full-time, B2B, and contract engagements
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SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with 10+ years of commercial experience building, modernizing, and supporting production PHP applications. Strong expertise in PHP 8, Symfony, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, application profiling, database optimization, automated testing, and production diagnostics. Experienced in improving existing systems, identifying memory leaks, modernizing legacy applications, and introducing practical engineering quality controls.

Comfortable working independently in distributed environments, collaborating through code reviews and written technical communication, and communicating directly with international clients.
Alongside hands-on development, I have experience mentoring engineers, coordinating small development teams, and running a developer training program at Simtech, where I received the Best Coach 2021 award.

EDUCATION

Specialist Degree - Mathematical Support and Administration of Information Systems 2009-2014
Ulyanovsk State University
Five-year specialist program combining software engineering, applied mathematics, algorithms, databases, and information systems design.

EXPERIENCE

Senior PHP Developer / Lead Programmer June 2025 - January 2026
ELAR Corporation
• Developed and maintained backend systems processing large datasets and generating business documents.
• Profiled existing applications to identify excessive memory usage and slow data-processing operations.
• Optimized resource-intensive workflows and moved suitable operations to background processing.
• Developed memory-efficient XLSX and Word document generation.
• Maintained compatibility across multiple PHP versions and contributed to the development of a Symfony 6.4 application.
• Analyzed database queries and improved application interaction with PostgreSQL.
• Environment: PHP 7-8.3, Symfony 6.4, PostgreSQL, Docker, PHPUnit, PhpSpreadsheet, PhpWord.

Senior PHP Developer February 2023 - February 2025
SourceCode
Developed and supported backend services for large municipal digital platforms, including healthcare appointments, utility reporting, event management, and property rental services.
• Designed and implemented backend functionality using PHP and Symfony.
• Refactored legacy services and separated business logic from infrastructure concerns.
• Increased automated test coverage on one of the services from approximately 20% to 70%.
• Introduced mutation testing and strengthened automated quality controls.
• Migrated application locking to PostgreSQL using Symfony Lock.
• Developed JWT authentication and OpenAPI documentation.
• Integrated with unstable external APIs and introduced defensive error-handling mechanisms.
• Participated in technical planning, code reviews, and mentoring of other developers.
• Environment: PHP 8, Symfony 5.4-7, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, OpenSearch, PHPUnit, Codeception, Infection, PHPStan, Psalm.

PHP Developer April 2022 - March 2023
Optimax Dev
Worked on the international e-commerce platform GlassesUSA.com.
• Contributed to the migration of legacy Magento functionality into Symfony-based services.
• Developed and maintained backend functionality for a high-traffic production platform.
• Improved automated testing and achieved a 97% Mutation Score Indicator using Infection.
• Investigated application behavior, integrations, and database-related performance issues.
• Worked in a distributed development environment on a product serving international customers.
• Environment: PHP, Symfony, Magento, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Docker, PHPUnit, Infection.

PHP Developer and Technical Mentor November 2019 - March 2022
Simtech
• Developed e-commerce applications using PHP, CS-Cart, and Laravel.
• Implemented custom functionality for international customers.
• Integrated payment providers including Stripe, PayPal, and Nochex.
• Estimated development tasks and participated in technical solution planning.
• Communicated directly with international clients in English.
• Investigated architectural issues and contributed fixes to shared product code.
• Environment: PHP, CS-Cart, Laravel, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Nginx, Apache, JavaScript.

PHP Developer / Team Coordinator August 2017 - November 2019
DaoTech
• Developed and maintained e-commerce platforms and custom PHP applications.
• Worked with X-Cart, CS-Cart, WordPress, OpenCart, Yii, CodeIgniter, and Slim.
• Implemented integrations and extended existing customer functionality.
• Coordinated the work of two developers, distributed tasks, and assisted with technical decisions.
• Communicated with customers and participated in task estimation.
• Maintained and gradually improved legacy PHP applications.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: PHP 7-8.4, Symfony, Doctrine ORM, Eloquent, Laravel, Yii2, Wordpress, CodeIgniter, custom frameworks
Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDb, Clickhouse
Performance: Xdebug, XHProf, memory profiling, memory leak investigation, SQL profiling, background processing
Testing and quality: PHPUnit, Codeception, Infection, PHPStan, Psalm, PHP-CS-Fixer, unit and integration testing
Infrastructure: Docker, Linux, Nginx, Redis, OpenSearch, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, SSH
Architecture: SOLID, dependency injection, domain-oriented design, CQRS, hexagonal architecture, idempotent processing
Additional experience: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Vite, CS-Cart, X-Cart, WordPress, CodeIgniter, Slim
AI-assisted development: ChatGPT, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Codex, human review gates, automated tests and static analysis

SELECTED ENGINEERING IMPACT

- Reduced memory usage of a data-processing workflow by approximately 3 GB.
- Improved the execution time of a resource-intensive process by approximately 60%.
- Increased automated test coverage on a production service from approximately 20% to 70%.
- Achieved a 97% Mutation Score Indicator using Infection.
- Investigated memory leaks and performance degradation in existing production applications.
- Built memory-efficient processing for XLSX files containing more than 10,000 rows.
- Developed reusable Symfony components for health checks, operation logging, and exception handling.
- Automated application build and deployment using GitHub Actions, SSH, and rsync.

SIMTECH DEVELOPER SCHOOL

- Led a training program for junior PHP developers.
- Created learning plans, practical assignments, and technical video materials.
- Reviewed student code and provided structured technical feedback.
- Helped developers with different initial skill levels prepare for commercial development.
- Participated in a selection process involving approximately 200 applicants, with around 10 candidates progressing through the complete program.
- Helped successful graduates transition into production development teams.
- Received the Best Coach 2021 award.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- Experience working with distributed teams and international customers.
- Strong background in production troubleshooting and legacy modernization.
- Comfortable taking ownership of tasks from investigation through production deployment.
- Interested in backend engineering roles that combine hands-on development, architectural influence, and technical mentorship.
- Open to remote full-time employment, B2B cooperation, contract projects, and relocation.